Foreign control and lobbying: what the records support

Private investigative pilot · 7 October 2026 · Final synthesis, superseding the checkpoint

The expanded search did **not establish that foreign control behind a major campaign was concealed**. It produced several reporting leads, substantial counterevidence and a reusable way to distinguish them. The strongest remaining major-campaign question concerns TransCanada PipeLines' historical registration. Its FARA relationship ended decades earlier, so it is not a contemporaneous conflict between the two regimes. The strongest recent cross-regime lead, Stark Aerospace, falls below this pilot's major-campaign threshold.

An important correction: Honda and Novartis quarterly filings expressly identify foreign parents. Earlier screening concentrated on registration checkboxes and missed those narratives. Their current campaigns should not be described as hiding foreign ownership. This correction is the most consequential result of the expanded audit.

Ranked reporting opportunities

These ranks reflect the value of further document-based reporting, **not a probability of wrongdoing**. They are analyst judgments informed by the original records. Jev's legal rankings did not pass validation and are withheld. No case establishes intent.

1. TransCanada PipeLines Limited — a historical parent-disclosure question; major, but no contemporaneous FARA collision. The 16 December 2010 registration, section 14 answers No. The client is openly Canadian and lists its Calgary address; the activity concerns natural gas and US/Canadian climate legislation. The company's 2009 information form, physical pages 4 and 22 describes the 2003 share arrangement and TransCanada Corporation's ownership of all common shares. Its 2010 financial report, physical page 96, note 1 describes it as wholly owned. These annual snapshots support a control question at registration, but are not a daily share register or proof about every preferred share class.

The legal client is independently anchored by its April 2010 SEC filing: CIK 0000099070, distinct from parent CIK 0001232384. Registration was 41 days after the stated effective date, within the 45-day period. Original quarterly amounts total $150,000 for 2010 Q4 and $1.33 million for 2011; 2025 expenses were $2.72 million. None of 67 acquired HTML forms contains a foreign-interest narrative naming the parent. The FARA inventory relationship with Mayer, Brown & Platt ran from 1981 to 1987, before the 2003 structure. The old Exhibit A is inaccessible. Strongest innocent explanation: a registration interpretation or clerical error involving a client whose foreign identity was already public. Decisive missing records: the contemporaneous ownership register and any historical registration correction or explanatory filing. Classification: documented checkbox/ownership tension, no finding of concealment or a FARA obligation.

2. Stark Aerospace — strongest recent cross-regime lead, below the major threshold. Bramer’s August 2024 registration, section 14 and Emanuel’s October 2025 registration answer No. The December 2025 FARA Exhibit A/B, pages 1, 5, 12 and 17, identifies the Stark–IAI North America–Israel Aerospace Industries chain. IAI's 2024 financial statements, page 55, note 11(c) provide an original ownership anchor; adjacent-year statements support continuity but do not replace a dated share register. Acquired 2025 outside lobbying income totals $136,500. The FARA contract's $270,000 commitment and $100,000 expense cap are not receipts or LDA spending. Emanuel's quarterly narrative expressly describes Arrow missile defense as a joint US–Israeli program, countering any claim that its international character was hidden. Separate engagements or activity changes can explain different regimes; they do not by themselves resolve the ownership checkbox. Missing: dated intermediary ownership records and any correcting registration. Classification: unresolved disclosure question, not a major-campaign finding.

3. Prvo Plinarsko Drustvo / Mercury — a same-entity transition worth reconciling, not a million-dollar campaign. The February 2025 LDA registration answers No. The May FARA Exhibit A/B, pages 2 and 10 has a negative/blank ownership response and a contract identifying the same company and address. Croatian identifiers MBS 030070559 and OIB 58292277611 distinguish the entity from similarly named companies. The preceding-stage issuer accounts identify Blue Horizon as owner; ENNA ceased to be owner in August 2023. A changed engagement from 15 April offers a plausible regime-transition explanation. Amended quarterly income reduces the apparent $1.2 million quarter to $120,000; annual numeric income is $250,000 plus a below-$5,000 quarter. Missing: an original ownership record effective on the filing dates and any explanatory amendments. Classification: unresolved ownership answers across regimes; materially downgraded campaign size.

4. Arm Limited / FGS — LDA ownership question, no verified FARA pair; nonmajor. The September 2025 registration answers No. Companies House identifiers separate Arm Limited 02557590 from Arm Holdings 11299879. Original control notices and accounts in the preceding-stage dossier support the parent chain. A prior 2023 registration by Carmen Group expressly lists SoftBank and Vision Fund interests, substantial counterevidence to a broad concealment narrative. A $1.1 million quarter was amended to $110,000; annual income is $210,000. Missing: the exact filing-date control chain and any correction by FGS. Classification: registration-specific inconsistency, not established concealment.

5. Honda — historical checkbox question; current foreign ownership expressly disclosed. The April 2012 amendment prints Honda North America and answers No. It must not be relabeled American Honda merely because the current API does so. Honda's 2012 Form 20-F, printed page 25 separately lists Honda North America Inc. and American Honda Motor Co., Inc., each with 100% ownership/voting interests. Original amended 2012 expenses total $2,117,350.49. However, 2018 Q1, section 19 and 2025 Q1, section 19 explicitly name Honda Motor Co., Ltd., Japan as parent; 35 acquired narratives do so. The old FARA Exhibit A is blocked. Missing initial registration and dated corporate succession records prevent a complete historical reconstruction. Classification: downgrade to historical form consistency; withdraw current concealed-control interpretation.

6. ELTA North America — small, registration-specific question. The April 2025 registration answers No; IAI financial statements list ownership, while a product sheet corroborates address but is not a legal-entity identifier. Annual acquired income is $87,500 to below $92,500. No exact FARA pair was established. Missing: exact legal identity, intermediary control on the registration date and correcting filings. Classification: insufficient identity/control evidence for a stronger conclusion.

7. KuCoin / A10 — major spending, ownership inference withheld. The February registration answers No; Q1 and Q2 each report $1 million and explicitly state that the client is a foreign company. The brand is not safely equated to Peken, Phoenixfin or another group entity. Unrelated criminal proceedings do not establish lobbying violations. Missing: the actual contracting legal client and filing-date ownership. Classification: abstain on concealed control; foreign identity is expressly disclosed.

8. IAI North America / Emanuel — possible completeness question in an already disclosed foreign chain. A 2024 amendment expressly lists IAI at 100%; the question concerns the ultimate State interest, not hidden foreign ownership. Acquired annual income is $24,000. The Pillsbury comparison filing lists both IAI and the State with zero contributions. Missing: complete dated chain and how the particular registration applied the control test. Classification: low-priority completeness review.

Cases that substantially weakened the hypothesis

Novartis: 2008 Q1, section 19 already identifies Novartis AG as parent of Novartis Corporation. Eighty-three acquired forms contain the parent narrative, including both quarters bracketing the

2011 amendment and 2025 Q1. A negative historical checkbox is not evidence that the parent was hidden across the filings. The $7.788 million 2025 campaign is removed from the concealed-control lead list.

Gotion: the in-house registration, Mercury and Vogel registrations all expressly report Chinese ownership. The FARA Exhibit A/B, pages 2, 5–6 names an immediate Chinese parent and describes Michigan legal/government work. The issuer's 2024 annual report, physical pages 321–323 supplies intermediate/indirect holdings. Exact translated US entity aliases remain unresolved, so chain completeness is not certified. In-house 2025 expenses are $2,459,072; outside reported income of $1,575,000 is separate and must not be added. FARA termination in April 2025 ended an engagement, not proven ownership. Classification: express foreign disclosure; immediate-versus-ultimate chain requires care.

The additional role screen found 13 major relationships, 12 beyond the initial major client matches. Hyundai, Toyota, Nissan, T-Mobile, US Steel, Samsung, BMO and Nutrien expressly describe foreign interests or owners. Zurich's group name is not automatically the same legal entity as the FARA principal; RAI's ultimate-parent reference is not identity with a named South American branch. Canadian railway association members are not presumed owners of the association. Northeastern's Irish interests do not prove foreign university ownership. Royal Bank of Canada must not be confused with the nested phrase Bank of Canada. These are counterexamples or unresolved identities, not new hidden-control findings. The complete 13-case assessment and 49 byte-verified selected XML originals are in the annex files.

Futurewei, Qatar/Bachner and the IAI/Pillsbury comparison also contain affirmative foreign disclosures. Alibaba entities and former SoftBank holdings cannot be collapsed into a current control claim. These negative controls matter: name overlap and a No checkbox are not sufficient evidence.

Actual coverage and materiality

The supplied DOJ inventories contain 7,090 registrant rows, 17,765 principal relationships and 154,309 document rows, with 126,480 distinct PDF URLs. Inventory rows are discovery records, not 154,309 documents read. The matched House source is the complete set of five official 2025 report-year XML archives: **109,389 records**, comprising 101,537 quarterly documents and 7,852 registrations/amendments. The quarterly records represent 97,567 relationship-quarters plus 3,970 additional versions. All carry report year 2025, but signing dates run through 2 October 2026. Signing is not filing receipt; this is not a census of documents received during 2025.

Client-name matching generated 598 discovery edges involving 222 House relationships; only 29 relationships had a principal-period overlap with 2025. The additional foreign-entity, affiliate and narrative screen generated 576 edges involving 149 relationships. Their union is **343 relationships**, of which **25** met the numeric major threshold. All 25 received original-based materiality and disclosure review; 318 did not qualify on acquired numeric data and are not cleared of disclosure concerns. This is a bounded review of discovered relationships, not exhaustive resolution of every corporate alias or all US lobbying.

“Major” means at least $1 million in the sum of selected 2025 quarterly income **or** in-house expenses for a registrant–client relationship after amendments. Historical leads use their explicitly named year. Income and expenses are not combined, nor are overlapping outside fees added to in-house spending. These figures measure reported lobbying scale, not foreign funding. Unknown/below-threshold values are not certified zeros. Across the major review and Gotion comparisons, 122 distinct 2025 original amount checks agreed with API amounts and posted-date amendment ordering. Three additional historical annual/partial-year checks are separately preserved.

The combined acquired original-form audit contains 4,143 distinct LDA documents: 3,658 HTML forms parsed without structural exceptions and 485 image/PDF forms on which automated narrative extraction abstained. There are 1,045 HTML forms with nonempty foreign-interest narratives. Five selected image pages were visually adjudicated; OCR remains a search aid. A Hyundai image demonstrated that an API foreign-entity array could actually reflect an affiliate section, so API role labels are not treated as original evidence.

In this continuation, eight modern DOJ PDF URLs were recognized by the browser reader, with varying excerpt coverage; ten selected historical Exhibits remained inaccessible. These counts do not imply full PDF downloads or complete page review. Direct DOJ downloads and the original attached guide transfer were blocked. The guide's matching repository card and the user's quoted item 10 supplied the task definition. None of the access failures was treated as an absent filing.

Rules applied at the relevant time

The 2010 version of 2 USC 1603 required registration within 45 days and identified foreign entities through at least 20% ownership, specified control or planning of lobbying activity, or qualifying affiliate interests. A foreign owner's zero contribution does not remove an otherwise applicable ownership/control condition. The inflation-adjusted thresholds for 2009–2012 were $3,000 in outside quarterly income and $11,500 in in-house expenses, documented in GAO-10-499, physical page 8 and GAO-12-492, physical page 9. The unadjusted statute dollar amounts are not substituted for those thresholds.

The saved February 2025 House/Senate guidance supplies the contemporary thresholds: $3,500 outside income and $16,000 in-house expenses; the prior 2021–2024 values were $3,000 and $14,000. Registration thresholds and the separate 20% lobbying-time definition are not inferred solely from campaign size. Quarterly amendment duties and the particular form's instructions must be applied to the actual registrant and activity.

FARA is activity- and relationship-dependent. Foreign corporate ownership alone does not establish a FARA obligation. The commercial exemption and the LDA exemption have different conditions; foreign-government/political-party principal-beneficiary issues require separate examination. FARA Exhibit A changes are governed by 28 CFR 5.201(b)'s ten-day provision; 5.208 is not the correct general citation for that claim. No database mismatch, later acquisition or move between regimes establishes concealment. The preceding-stage legal annex preserves the primary statutes, regulations, guidance and their retrieval records.

What Jev added—and did not

Fifty paid calls across the two preceding stages produced an estimated total of **$0.003035**, against the same authorized $15 ceiling. The conservative reservation-based all-call bound was $0.15; these are client records, not a provider invoice. No additional paid calls were made for the full-inventory continuation. No other paid service was used.

Jev did not deliver a validated legal ranking. Its earlier case judgments failed consistency/control checks, so numerical legal scores are withheld. On the later narrow extraction exercise, Jev and the code-only baseline both passed all 16 listed items. That list contained two distinct real-form payloads, six synthetic controls and eight cache hits—not 16 independent original documents. This establishes neither legal accuracy nor a measured advantage over code. The useful demonstrable improvements came from acquiring more originals, separating document roles, applying amendment chronology and auditing narratives. Future model use should be restricted to source-cited extraction with abstention until independently calibrated.

The stopping boundary is evidence access and the declared screen, not budget exhaustion: the full five-archive role screen and its major discovered cohort are complete, accessible follow-up records have been reconciled, and the remaining decisive historical Exhibits/dated ownership records were

not obtained through authorized free routes. The 318 numerically nonmajor relationships and unmatched aliases remain a possible new scope, not completed legal investigations. No outreach, purchases, new accounts or public accusations were made.

Technical annex and replay map

Read REPORT.md first. Prior checkpoints preserve the chronology but are superseded where the final report corrects narrative omissions.

Data and audit outputs

- supplied-source-provenance.json, csv-parse-audit.json: byte-preserved supplied DOJ inventories, source revision and reversible CSV parsing repairs. Local row numbers are locators, not official principal identifiers.

- house-archive-downloads.json, house-parse-coverage.json, archive-scope.json: official download URLs, hashes, complete parsing and document/version denominators. Four illegal XML character references are repaired only in the parsing representation; original bytes remain unchanged.

- full-inventory-edges.json, full-role-edges.json, cohort-triage.json: every discovery edge and disposition for the 343-relationship union. Name normalization is a candidate generator, not entity verification. Narrative search requires a bounded normalized core of at least 12 characters and two words; single-word aliases and unfamiliar corporate names can be missed.

- major-original-reconciliation.json, major-amount-verification.json, role-annual-verification.json, historical-amount-verification.json: original amounts, amendment chronology, source links and selected versions. 25 major relationships, plus the two Gotion outside comparisons, produce 122 distinct original 2025 amount checks.

- major-role-review.json and sources/selected-house-originals/: role-specific assessments and byte-verified original XML. These retain affiliates, foreign entities and interested parties separately.

- all-original-interest-audit.json, all-original-interest-coverage.json: original section-19 narrative audit, explicit structural exceptions/abstentions and paths. Historical API labels are never substituted for names printed on originals.

- manual-image-review.json: five visually checked pages and limits. OCR text is not an original or a substitute for visual checkbox review.

- historical-registration-context.json: completed registrant-scoped RR/RA searches for Honda, Novartis and TransCanada; an empty query is not proof that no registration exists.

- sources/browser-*.json and retrieval-ledger.jsonl: saved primary-source browser extracts and failures. These are reader captures, not claimed original PDF bytes. Excerpts may be incomplete.

Reproducible sequence

Run from the repository root with Python 3. The initial ingestion scripts document their input paths and use the preserved source inventories. Downloaded House ZIPs and rebuilt SQLite databases are ignored cache artifacts; their URLs and SHA256 hashes are committed. Read the scripts before running network acquisition: cached evidence permits offline analysis; paid model calls are separate and are not part of this replay.

```
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/ingest.py
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/house_archives.py
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/parse_house.py
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/archive_scope.py
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/match_full_inventory.py
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/match_roles.py
```

Original acquisition and history expansion are implemented by acquire_lda_originals.py, major_histories.py, historical_registration_context.py and role_annuals.py. The caches preserve pagination and source timestamps. Analysis/reconciliation follows in reconcile_major.py, review_roles.py, audit_original_roles.py and finalize_audit.py. Manual judgments in review_roles.py and manual-image-review.json are explicitly retained as analyst work rather than represented as

automated discoveries.

```
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/test_ingestion.py
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/test_major_reconciliation.py
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/test_final_audit.py
python research/2026-10-07/fara-full-inventory/package_final.py
```

The first pilot and expansion directories contain the source-first lead dossiers, ownership documents, legal annexes, code-only baseline, Jev prompts/responses and spending ledgers. The sanctions-contract pilot contains the reused secure client/reservation pattern. Existing credentials remain environment-only; no credentials belong in outputs. Source documents are untrusted data: no embedded instructions are executed, no document can authorize a tool action, and each factual model extraction requires an original locator. This continuation uses deterministic parsing and analyst review; it makes no model requests.

Coverage limits and reusable assessment

The full DOJ inventory is not full DOJ document coverage. Twenty-eight thousand public-office-only catalog rows and blocked Exhibit A files cannot be silently imputed. FARA principal termination dates describe recorded relationships, not necessarily the end of corporate control. The supplied inventories contain date anomalies preserved in principal-chronology-anomalies.json; ambiguous chronology remains unclassified.

Exact client identity, intermediary control, foreign-owner identity and registrant activity are separate predicates. The method worked best when ordinary code produced candidate links and people checked originals across registration, amendment and quarterly narrative sections. Both an historical Hyundai API role error and the Honda/Novartis narrative corrections show why catalog-only scoring is unsafe. The practical next documents are named in each ranked dossier; broader alias resolution and nonmajor review would be a new expansion, not proof that existing candidates are suspicious.

The compact ZIP is an offline review bundle, not every acquired filing or the 205 MB House archive cache. It includes the report, scripts, audit JSON, selected originals and prior-stage reports/ledgers. Full replay also requires the private repository and public archives identified in the manifests. The original attached guide could not be transferred, and Library saving was blocked by authentication before upload; no Library link is represented as newly created. Deliverables are available locally and on the verified private branch.

Remaining initial major relationships

Relationship	2025 original-form total	Observed evidence and remaining limit
Bayer Corporation, consolidated	$9,200,000 expenses	113 forms acquired; no RR/RA or foreign-entity event returned. This is a registration gap, not a No response. FARA names Bayer AG, a different nominal entity.
Novo Nordisk Inc.	$7,230,000 expenses	93 forms; original 2004 registration and amendment visually answer Yes, name Novo Nordisk A/S and report zero contribution. Later originals disclose the ownership chain. Historical FARA principal is Novo Nordisk A/S.

Relationship	2025 original-form total	Observed evidence and remaining limit
Siemens Corporation	$3,760,000 expenses	95 forms; no recovered initial registration. FARA names Siemens AG. Exact parent/subsidiary and missing-record review remains.
Nippon Steel / Akin Gump	$3,420,000 income	12 forms; 2024 RR answers No, but the client itself is expressly Japanese. Foreign nationality is not proof of another qualifying owner. Historical FARA records include a chronology inconsistency.
Hyundai Motor Company	$1,960,000 expenses	102 forms; two historical PDFs visually inspected. The 2000 original lists Hyundai under affiliated organizations, not foreign entities; the amendment is Self and answers No. API foreign_entities does not faithfully identify that original section.
Nestle USA	$1,737,352 expenses	95 forms; original 2009–10 quarterly updates expressly list Nestle SA at 100%. Historical FARA identity and current ownership percentages still need date-specific treatment.
Volvo Car Corporation	$1,495,000 expenses	66 forms; 2010 RR answers Yes, naming Volvo Car Corporation at 100%. FARA name is Volvo Car BV; the match is not a proved legal identity or complete ownership chain.
BMW of North America LLC	$1,270,000 expenses	63 forms; original 2011 RR answers Yes, naming BMW AG at 100%. FARA catalog dates are internally inconsistent, not evidence that BMW misfiled.
Cameco Corporation	$1,040,000 expenses	52 forms; 2018 RA answers No and expressly identifies a Canadian registrant/address. No evidence yet of an undisclosed qualifying separate foreign owner.

Read these limits alongside the expanded narrative audit. These are observed source dispositions, not legal clearances. Database role labels must always be confirmed against the original section. The additional 13 major role matches are individually documented in major-role-review.json, with one overlap (Hyundai) yielding 25 major relationships overall.